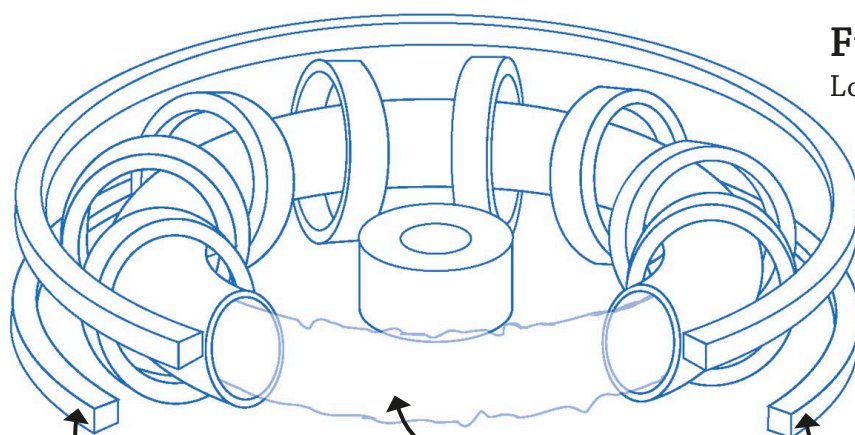


Future of energy

Scientists are always coming up with new ideas for ways to use energy and make electricity. Some of these ideas might sound far-fetched or strange, but many of the great energy discoveries from the past seemed strange at the time, too!



Hydrogen is used as fuel in the doughnut-shaped reactor.

The hydrogen is heated until the nuclei of its atoms start joining together.

The superhot hydrogen, called plasma, is held in place with magnets.

Fusion reactor

Lots of energy is released by the Sun when the nuclei of its atoms join together, in the process called nuclear fusion. Scientists are working on machines called fusion reactors that try and recreate this, to make huge amounts of electricity.

People power

“Piezoelectric” devices can make electricity out of movement. In a train station in Japan, pedestrians could walk on tiles that created electric currents when they were squashed. The electricity they created powered Christmas lights.



Stepping on these panels creates electricity.